

Outline { partial trace, reduced density operator
quantum operation (§3.5) '20.11.06.
(~ §3.3)

Thm 3.15 & Def 3.16 (partial trace)

Let $\mathcal{H}^A, \mathcal{H}^B$: Hilbert spaces with ONBs $\{|e_a\rangle\}$ and $\{|f_b\rangle\}$, and let $M \in L(\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B)$ and $M_{a_1 b_1, a_2 b_2}$ be the matrix of M in ONB $\{|e_{a_1} \otimes f_{b_1}\rangle\}$.

Define $\begin{cases} \underline{\text{tr}^B(M)} := \sum_{a_1, a_2, b} M_{a_1 b, a_2 b} |e_{a_1}\rangle \langle e_{a_2}| \in L(\mathcal{H}^A) \\ \underline{\text{tr}^A(M)} := \sum_{b_1, b_2, a} M_{a b_1, a b_2} |f_{b_1}\rangle \langle f_{b_2}| \in L(\mathcal{H}^B). \end{cases}$

Then, we have

(i) $\text{tr}^B(M)$ and $\text{tr}^A(M)$ do not depend on the choice of ONBs.

(ii) $\text{tr}^B(M)$ and $\text{tr}^A(M)$ are unique in the sense that

$$\begin{cases} \text{tr}(M^A \text{tr}^B(M)) = \text{tr}((M^A \otimes \mathbb{1}^B) M) \quad \forall M^A \in L(\mathcal{H}^A) \\ \text{tr}(M^B \text{tr}^A(M)) = \text{tr}((\mathbb{1}^A \otimes M^B) M) \quad \forall M^B \in L(\mathcal{H}^B). \end{cases}$$

(3.47)

Here, tr^B is called as the partial trace over $\mathcal{H}^B$ and tr^A is called as the partial trace over $\mathcal{H}^A$.

(sketch of the proof)

(i) (independence on ONB). Let $\{|e_a\rangle\}$ and $\{|\tilde{f}_b\rangle\}$ be two other ONBs. Then, $\exists U^A \in \mathcal{U}(\mathcal{H}^A), U^B \in \mathcal{U}(\mathcal{H}^B)$ s.t. $|e_a\rangle = U^A |e_a\rangle$ and $|\tilde{f}_b\rangle = U^B |f_b\rangle$.

(ii) Verification of (3.47): $M \in L(\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B)$

$$M = \sum_{a_1, a_2, b_1, b_2} M_{a_1 b_1, a_2 b_2} |e_{a_1} \otimes f_{b_1}\rangle \langle e_{a_2} \otimes f_{b_2}|.$$

For $M^A \in L(\mathcal{H}^A)$, $M^A = \sum_{a_1, a_2} M^A_{a_1, a_2} |e_{a_1}\rangle \langle e_{a_2}|$

(iii) (Uniqueness) Let $\widetilde{\text{tr}^B(M)}$ be another operator on $\mathcal{H}^A$ satisfying (3.47)₁.

Then, $\text{tr} \left(\underbrace{M^A}_{\text{red circle}} \underbrace{(\widetilde{\text{tr}^B(M)} - \text{tr}^B(M))}_{\text{red wavy line}} \right) = 0$ □

Remark (i) $\underbrace{\text{tr}(M^A \text{tr}^B(M))}_{\in L(\mathcal{H}^A)} = \text{tr} \left(\underbrace{(M^A \otimes \mathbb{1}^B)}_{\in L(\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B)} M \right)$

Thus, $\text{tr}^B(M)$ is a unique operator satisfying the relation above.

(ii) $\text{tr} : L(\mathcal{H}) \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$: complex number. ; "trace"

$\text{tr}^B : L(\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B) \rightarrow L(\mathcal{H}^A)$; "partial trace"

Exercise 3.42 For any $M \in \mathcal{L}(\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B)$,
 $\text{tr}(\text{tr}^B(M)) = \text{tr}(M) = \text{tr}(\text{tr}^A(M))$.

Thm 3.17 & Def 3.18 (Reduced density operator).

Let $\rho \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B)$ be a density operator on $\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B$.

(i) Then, $\rho^A(\rho) := \text{tr}^B(\rho)$ is the uniquely determined density operator.

(ii) For any bounded observable $M^A \in \mathcal{B}_{sa}(\mathcal{H}^A)$,
 (set of bounded and self-adjoint operator on $\mathcal{H}^A$)
 $\langle M^A \rangle_{\rho^A(\rho)} = \langle M^A \otimes \mathbb{1}^B \rangle_{\rho}$.

(iii) $\{|e_a\rangle\}, \{|f_b\rangle\}$: ONBs in $\mathcal{H}^A$ and $\mathcal{H}^B$.

$P_{a_1 b_1, a_2 b_2}$: matrix of ρ in ONB $\{|e_{a_1} \otimes f_{b_1}\rangle\}$ in $\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B$.

Then, $\rho^A(\rho)_{a_1 a_2} = \sum_b P_{a_1 b, a_2 b}$ — (3.52)

Here, $\rho^A(\rho)$ is called as the reduced density operator.

(Sketch of the proof)

(i) ($\rho^A(\rho)$: density operator)

- self-adj. : $(\rho^A(\rho)_{a_1 a_2})^* = \rho^A(\rho)_{a_1 a_2}$

$\because (\rho^A(\rho)_{a_1 a_2})^* = \frac{\rho^A(\rho)_{a_2 a_1}}{\rho^A(\rho)_{a_2 a_1}} = \sum_b P_{a_2 b, a_1 b}$

$(\rho = \rho^*)$
 $= \sum_b P_{a_1 b, a_2 b} = \rho^A(\rho)_{a_1 a_2}$

- positivity: For any $|\psi\rangle \in \mathbb{H}^A$,

$$\langle \psi | \rho^A(p) | \psi \rangle = \sum_{a_1, a_2} \overline{\psi_{a_1}} \rho^A(p)_{a_1 a_2} \psi_{a_2}$$

$$= \sum_{a_1, a_2, b} \overline{\psi_{a_1}} \rho_{a_1 b, a_2 b} \psi_{a_2} = \sum_b \langle \psi \otimes f_b | \rho(\psi \otimes f_b) \rangle \geq 0.$$

$$\begin{aligned} - \operatorname{tr}(\rho^A) &= 1; \quad \operatorname{tr}(\rho^A(p)) = \operatorname{tr}(\operatorname{tr}^B(p)) \\ &= \operatorname{tr}(p) = 1. \end{aligned}$$

$$(ii) \langle M^A \otimes \mathbb{1}^B \rangle_p = \operatorname{tr}((M^A \otimes \mathbb{1}^B)p) = \operatorname{tr}(M^A \operatorname{tr}^B(p))$$

$$= \operatorname{tr}(M^A \rho^A(p)) = \langle M^A \rangle_{\rho^A(p)}$$

($\therefore$ The quantum mechanical expectation value of an observable A in a mixed state p $\langle A \rangle_p := \operatorname{tr}(pA)$.)

Remark $\rho^A(p)$ is the state obtained from the state $p \in \mathcal{D}(\mathbb{H}^A \otimes \mathbb{H}^B)$ by taking partial trace over subsystem B . ; $\rho^A(p) = \operatorname{tr}^B(p)$

Exercise 3.43. $M^A \in L(\mathbb{H}^A)$, $M^B \in L(\mathbb{H}^B)$.

$$M^A \otimes M^B \in L(\mathbb{H}^A \otimes \mathbb{H}^B)$$

$$(i) \operatorname{tr}(M^A \otimes M^B) = \operatorname{tr}(M^A) \cdot \operatorname{tr}(M^B)$$

$$(ii) \operatorname{tr}^B(M^A \otimes M^B) = \operatorname{tr}(M^B) M^A$$

$$(iii) \operatorname{tr}^A(M^A \otimes M^B) = \operatorname{tr}(M^A) M^B.$$

Exercise 3.45 V : finite dim'd v-sp. over a field F .

$$L(V^{\otimes n}) = L(V)^{\otimes n}$$



$\mathbb{H}$: qubit Hilbert space $\simeq \mathbb{C}^2$.

a system of n qubits is described $\mathbb{H}^{\otimes n}$.

In general, any observable of such system or its operator on n qubits.

$\iff$ any such operator can be represented as a linear combination of n -fold tensor products of operators on $\mathbb{H}$.

Remark This does not mean that every $A \in L(V^n)$ is of the form

$$A = A_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes A_n \quad \text{for some } \{A_i\} \in L(V).$$

$$A = \sum_j a_{j_1, \dots, j_n} A_{j_1} \otimes \cdots \otimes A_{j_n} \quad \{A_{j_i}\} \in L(V).$$

(sketch of the proof).

claim (i) $L(V^{\otimes n}) \subseteq L(V)^{\otimes n}$ (ii) $\dim(L(V^{\otimes n})) = \dim(L(V)^{\otimes n})$

(i) Any $w \in V^{\otimes n}$, $w = \sum w_{j_1, \dots, j_n} v_{j_1} \otimes \cdots \otimes v_{j_n}$

$\{v_j\}_{j=1}^{\dim V}$: basis of V .

For any $A_1, \dots, A_n \in L(V)$,

$$(A_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes A_n)w = \sum_{j_1, \dots, j_n} w_{j_1, \dots, j_n} (A_1 v_{j_1}) \otimes \cdots \otimes (A_n v_{j_n}).$$

$$\Rightarrow A_1 \otimes \dots \otimes A_n \in L(V^{\otimes n})$$

$$\text{ii)} \quad \dim L(V) = (\dim V)^2, \quad \dim (V^{\otimes n}) = (\dim V)^n$$

$$\Rightarrow \dim (L(V)^{\otimes n}) = (\dim L(V))^n = (\dim V)^{2n}$$

$$\dim L(V^{\otimes n}) = (\dim V^{\otimes n})^2 = (\dim V)^{2n}.$$

§ 3.5 Quantum operation

There are two ways that a quantum system can change

(i) by unitary time evolution by some Hamiltonian

(ii) a state transformation by a measurement

Motivation

1. For a system A of our interest, $\rho^A \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{H}^A)$.

2. Combine (A, ρ^A) with the environment (B, ρ^B) .

$$\iota_{\rho^B} : \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{H}^A) \rightarrow \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B)$$

$$\rho^A \mapsto \rho^A \otimes \rho^B$$

3. $U \in \mathcal{U}(\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B)$; $U : \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B) \rightarrow \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B)$
 $\rho^A \otimes \rho^B \mapsto \underline{U(\rho^A \otimes \rho^B)U^\dagger}$

4. P^B : projection onto the eigenspace of an observable of B.

$$\blacksquare = U(\rho^A \otimes \rho^B)U^\dagger \mapsto \frac{(\mathbb{1}^A \otimes P^B) \blacksquare (\mathbb{1}^A \otimes P^B)}{\text{tr}((\mathbb{1}^A \otimes P^B) \blacksquare)}$$

Note This measurement

$$\rho \xrightarrow{\text{state before measurement}} \frac{P \rho P}{\text{tr}(P \rho)} : \text{state after measurement.}$$

5. Finally, ignoring B , we can obtain a description of syst. A by taking the partial trace over B .

$$\frac{(\mathbb{1}^A \otimes P^B) \rho (\mathbb{1}^A \otimes P^B)}{\text{tr}((\mathbb{1}^A \otimes P^B) \rho)} \xrightarrow{\text{partial trace over } B} \frac{\text{tr}^B((\mathbb{1}^A \otimes P^B) \rho (\mathbb{1}^A \otimes P^B))}{\text{tr}((\mathbb{1}^A \otimes P^B) \rho)}$$

$\in D(\mathcal{H}^A \otimes \mathcal{H}^B)$
 $\in D(\mathcal{H}^A)$

ρ^A

Our goal is to represent $(*)$ in terms of suitable operators on $\mathcal{H}^A$ only.

Lemma 3.23

$\mathcal{H}$: Hilbert, $\{K_\ell\}_{\ell=1}^m \subseteq \mathcal{L}(\mathcal{H})$. Then, for any

$\rho \in D(\mathcal{H})$,

the operator $K(\rho) = \sum_{\ell=1}^m K_\ell \rho K_\ell^*$ satisfies

(i) $K(\rho)^* = K(\rho)$: self-adj.

(ii) $K(\rho) \geq 0$: positive.

(iii) Moreover, for $\delta \in (0, 1]$ and $\rho \in D(\mathcal{H})$.

$$\sum_{\ell=1}^m K_\ell^* K_\ell \leq \delta \mathbb{1} \iff \text{tr}(K(\rho)) \leq \delta$$

Thm 3.24 & Def 3.26 (Quantum operation).

H^A : finite dim'l Hilbert, $K: D(H^A) \rightarrow \underbrace{D(H^A)}_1$

$$\{ \rho \in D(H^A) : \rho^* = \rho, \rho \geq 0, \text{tr}(\rho) \leq 1 \}.$$

Then, for $\delta \in (0, 1]$, TPAE

(i) $\exists H^B$: finite dim'l, $V \in B(H^A \otimes H^B)$, $\rho^B \in D(H^B)$
s.t. $V^* V \leq \delta \mathbb{1}^{AB}$ and $K(\rho^A) = \text{tr}^B (V(\rho^A \otimes \rho^B) V^*)$
(3.74)

(ii) $\exists \{K_\ell\}_{\ell=1}^m \subseteq L(H^A)$ s.t.

$$\sum_{\ell=1}^m K_\ell^* K_\ell \leq \delta \mathbb{1}^A \text{ and } K(\rho^A) = \sum_{\ell=1}^m K_\ell \rho^A K_\ell^* \quad (3.76)$$

Here, a quantum operation K is a convex-linear map that can be represented by (3.74) or (3.76).

Moreover, ⁽ⁱ⁾ if $K(\rho) = \sum_{\ell=1}^m K_\ell \rho K_\ell^*$ where $\{K_\ell\} \subseteq L(H)$

with $\sum_{\ell=1}^m K_\ell^* K_\ell \leq \mathbb{1}$, then $\{K_\ell\}$: Kraus operators.

is called as the operator-sum representation.

NOT unique

(ii) $K(\rho) = \text{tr}^B (V(\rho \otimes \rho^B) V^*)$ with $V^* V \leq \mathbb{1}$

is called as the environment representation

Remark (i) Thm 3.24 does not assert that every convex-linear map does not have one of the equivalent forms (3.174) or (3.176).

- (ii) environments rep. $\longleftrightarrow$ operator-sum rep.
- concrete and easy to related real-world
 - Mathematically inconvenient
 - rather abstract
 - useful for calculations.

Cor 3.27

$K: D(H) \rightarrow D_{\leq}(H)$: quantum operation with Kraus operators $\{K_\ell\}_{\ell=1}^m$.

For $\tilde{m} \geq m$ and $U \in U(\tilde{m})$: unitary matrix.

$\tilde{K}_j := \sum_{\ell=1}^m U_{j\ell} K_\ell$; $\{\tilde{K}_j\}_{j=1}^{\tilde{m}}$: Kraus operators

Summary

1. initially $\rho \in D(H)$
2. combine with another system (environment, error)
3. subject to $\begin{cases} \text{unitary time evolution} \\ \text{possible measurement.} \end{cases}$

4. $D(H) \rightarrow D(H)$
 $\rho \mapsto \frac{K(\rho)}{\text{tr}(K(\rho))}$: with the help of a quantum operation K .

Reference

[Quantum computation and quantum information, Nielsen and Chuang] ch 8. Quantum-noise and quantum operations.